

Key features:

- Uses Ruby, which has a great open source community and resources
- Contains a wide array of ready-made plugins
- Uses the MVC model of development
- Uses the MIT licence
- Highly cost- and time-effective for development

Rails has a very active open source community. The official repository on GitHub is used by 1.3 million developers and has over 18.1K forks. There is an abundance of online tutorials and books available to learn Rails. There are new releases every month, with the current release being v6.0.2.1.

Trends indicate that Rails developers get paid higher because, first, the use of Ruby is at an all-time low, with more developers shifting to JavaScript for Web development. Second, Ruby is a comparatively hard language to learn and has a steeper learning curve. This has led to fewer developers joining the Ruby community, making good programmers for Rails a priceless asset for many companies who depend on the framework. Rails is certainly not going away in 2020 or the foreseeable future. Therefore, if you are a newbie open source Web developer, keep Rails on your wishlist.

8. Spring

Spring is an open source Java based application development framework. It uses the MVC model and has many projects attached to its name that increase the versatility and use cases of the framework. While Spring can be counted upon as a Web development framework, it is used for a lot more than just that. MIT, Intuit, Fitbit and Accenture are among the big names that make use of Spring.

Key features:

- Has a wide array of sister projects

that can be used in the framework including a cloud based service

- Makes use of concepts like inversion of control and dependency injection that make the framework unique
- Uses the MVC model of development

Thanks to the huge number of Java developers, Spring has an active open source community with the official repository on GitHub being used by 135K developers and with 22.8K forks. Spring does have a fair bit of online tutorials available, but the learning curve is a bit steep as you are required to have a deep understanding of Java before you dive in. There are new releases every month, with the latest being v5.2.2.

There is a lot that you can do with Spring. It enables you to extend your Web application into many different domains, including the cloud. If you are comfortable with Java, then definitely go for it.

7. ASP.NET

ASP.NET is an open source server-side Web development framework, brought to you by Microsoft. It is based on the .NET framework. Web applications can be written using VBScript (Visual Basic Script) or C#. Launched in 2002, ASP.NET has grown in prominence. Microsoft, GoDaddy, Dell and Taco Bell are amongst the big names that use the ASP.NET framework for their websites.

Key features:

- Uses the MVC model of development
- .NET has been one of the most trusted frameworks in the industry
- Is ideal for developers who are already familiar with C#
- Fast compilation and execution of code (thanks to the .NET framework).

The open source community engagement is lower with ASP.NET. The official repository on GitHub is used by 2.2K developers while the

forks are at 4K. Having said that, you will find plenty of great resources online to learn the framework, as well as VBScript and C#. There are new releases every month for the .NET Core, the latest being v3.1.0.

While PHP beats ASP.NET in speed and performance, ASP.NET beats PHP in compilation and execution speed. You can build some pretty sturdy Web applications using ASP.NET. There is certainly a steep learning curve with C# or VBScript, but that is compensated for by some really good tutorials. If you are a moderately experienced Web developer, I would recommend giving ASP.NET a try.

6. Laravel

Anyone who uses PHP for Web development has at some point either used or heard of the Laravel framework. It is the most used PHP based open source Web development framework, and provides a huge ecosystem of different platforms that support different development needs. 9GAG, Swat.io and Pedidas are among the companies that use Laravel for Web development.

Key features:

- Uses PHP
- Follows the MVC model
- Has a huge ecosystem of different tools such as Vapor, Forge, Envoyer, etc
- Very secure in comparison to other PHP frameworks

Laravel has a pretty active open source community with the official repository on GitHub having 17.6K forks. Additionally, there is no lack of great quality free tutorials on Laravel. There is at least one release every month with the latest being v6.5.2.

Laravel can be an extremely handy framework to use. However, keep in mind that a good grasp of PHP is a necessary prerequisite. While there is nothing lacking in Laravel, per se, Django certainly seems to be a